

Social Work

Master of Social Work

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MISSION STATEMENT

The Graduate Social Work program prepares students to become competent, ethical and advanced professional social work practitioners capable of assuming a wide range of roles and functions in working with vulnerable individuals, families, groups, public and private organizations and institutions in rural and urban communities. The Graduate Social Work Program is accredited by the Council on Social Work Education.

ADMISSION REQUIREMENTS

Please see the general graduate admission requirements [here](#). Specific requirements to this program are as follows:

1. Submit two essays. Each essay should not exceed 500 words. Essays must focus on the following:
 - a. Why applicants wish to pursue the MSW degree;
 - b. A major contemporary social problem that is of concern to the profession of social work; (state why, in your opinion, it is a problem for the profession), and how you would intervene to ameliorate and/or eradicate this problem.
2. Submit three letters of reference that reflect the applicant's academic and professional potential and ethical and values orientation. Preferably letter of recommendations should be written by former professors or others who are, or who have been in a position to evaluate aspects of the candidates' academic, personal and intellectual capabilities.

While there is no requirement for a specific undergraduate major to qualify for graduate study in social work, applicants are expected to have had preparation in the liberal arts, usually through undergraduate coursework in the social and behavioral sciences, humanities and life sciences. At least 24 credits are required in these areas.

NOTE: Admission deadlines to the Graduate program will occur thrice annually – in the summer (Feb 15), in the fall (Mar 01), in the spring (Nov 30).

Advanced Standing

Applicants with a BSW degree from a CSWE accredited program and a cumulative GPA of 3.00 including upper division social work courses may apply for advanced standing.

DEGREE REQUIREMENTS

Students obtaining Advanced Standing must complete the degree program in three (3) consecutive semesters. Qualified applicants for Advanced Standing must complete 39 credit hours, of which 8 credit hours are in field instruction, to finish the degree program.

(SWKA-FCWA) Social Work – Family/Child Welfare – Advanced Standing Program – Thesis

45 Credit Hours

MinGPA cumulative 3.0. MinGrade C*. Degree M.S.W.

CORE COURSES	
SWK 522 Race, Ethnicity, Gender & Diversity	3
SWK 523 Rural Urban Social Work	2
SWK 587 Social Work Empowerment	3
CONCENTRATION	
SWK 600 Social Work Intervention Strategies	3
SWK 601 Social Work Practice w/ Groups	3
SWK 610 Family & Child Welfare Policy	3
SWK 621 Family Theories & Processes	3
SWK 630 Needs Assessment/Prgm Evaluation	3
SWK 660 Assessment of Individuals	3
SWK 680 Field Practicum & Seminar II	4
SWK 681 Field Practicum & Seminar III	4
SWK 689 Integrative Seminar	3
SWK Elective	2
THESIS	
Grade is Pass / Fail. MinHrs 6.	
SWK 631 Research Project/Thesis	1-3
SWK 632 Thesis Option	1-3
Oral Defense	

*One grade of C allowed at graduation.

(SWKA-FCWA) Social Work – Family/Child Welfare – Advanced Standing Program – Non-thesis

39 Credit Hours

MinGPA cumulative 3.0. MinGrade C*. Degree M.S.W.

CORE COURSES	
SWK 522 Race, Ethnicity, Gender & Diversity	3
SWK 523 Rural Urban Social Work	2
SWK 587 Social Work Empowerment	3
CONCENTRATION	
SWK 600 Social Work Intervention Strategies	3
SWK 601 Social Work Practice w/ Groups	3
SWK 610 Family & Child Welfare Policy	3
SWK 621 Family Theories & Processes	3
SWK 630 Needs Assessment/Prgm Evaluation	3 [RPP]
SWK 660 Assessment of Individuals	3
SWK 680 Field Practicum & Seminar II	4
SWK 681 Field Practicum & Seminar III	4
SWK 689 Integrative Seminar	3
SWK Elective	2
COMPREHENSIVE EXAM	
Grade is Pass / Fail.	
Exam composed jointly by Advisory Committee.	
To be taken after ≥ 66% completion of required coursework.	

*One grade of C allowed at graduation.

[RPP] = Research project paper or portfolio required.